Comprehensive Analysis for Redevelopment.
PLAN 3100: Sustainable Planning and Urban Design

THE FRONT RANGE FIRM
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Summary
The Site in question is in a northern suburban commercial neighborhood. The surrounding land uses support residential activity as well as commercial or industrial activity. The community is made up of a large range of ages and incomes. There is a large concentration of Hispanic residents in the surrounding neighborhood. The land use makeup is not very human scale. A lot of big boxes means a lot of parking, and not much community gathering space.
The current infrastructure is up to date and effective, but not for pedestrians. Circulation is car dominated, and the bike infrastructure included is not very protected. The utilities in and around the site are mostly concentrated under College Ave.
The site transitioned from a rural area to a more suburban neighborhood as Fort Collins expanded. The rural history persists in the somewhat low-density style of the neighborhood. The current conditions mostly support car-dependent growth.
There are some environmental concerns on the site, including a site of gasoline leaching into the soil. There is an extensive Environmental Assessment that must be considered when placing housing and other human-inhabited developments to ensure equity.

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location and
regional significance
The site is located in North Fort Collins, bordered by E Willow Ln, Blue Spruce Dr, Bristlecone Dr, and North College. The site's relative location to other FoCo culturally significant areas is described below:
Current site land use consists of:

- low density commercial activity
- big boxes = big parking lots
- strip mall, abandoned big box, offices, services

Adjacent
to the West:
mobile home community, more commerce, residential
to the North:
more big boxes, large parking lots
to the East:
single-family residential neighborhood

to the South:
more commerce, boat & RV parking, vacant land

Poverty
28.12% of residents in this area are living in poverty, the highest rate in Northern FoCO.
Persons w/ Disabilities
9.47% of residents in this area are living with one or more disabilities.
Median home values
Median home values range from $85,000 to $700,000 in this area.
Population Density
There are about 2,500 people per square mile in this area, a much lower density than downtown FoCO.
Ethnicity
This area of FoCo has the highest concentration of Hispanic residents. (50-70% of residents in surrounding census tracts.)
Age
The median age of the site is 26. Surrounding residential areas are higher (40-60), while mixed-use areas are consistently lower (25-35).

neighborhood character
As shown in the demographic data, this is a majority hispanic community. There is an organization called La Familia that works in the realm of community outreach, advocacy, resource allocation, and education for the spanish-speaking community.
The Hispanic residents mostly reside in the mobile home developments and the affordable housing. This community has been historically underserved by the city of Fort Collins. The North College area was one of the last in the city to receive city amenities. This legacy is still felt today.
When considering redevelopment in the North College neighborhood, the welfare and interest of the Hispanic community must be considered. Community engagement for the neighborhood in the past has specifically given a voice to the Hispanic community leaders. The URA has expressed a desire to serve this community with any future development.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT TAKEAWAYS
Main takeaways from a 2020 Community Engagement Report of the North College Neighborhood. Presented by the Urban Renewal Authority of Fort Collins after 9 community engagement workshops.

Economic Health
The site falls inside a Targeted Redevelopment Area and a designated Urban Renewal Area, signaling strong city interest in revitalization and reinvestment in this corridor. Additionally, the site lies within a Tax Increment Financing (TIF) District, which provides financial support to help fund infrastructure improvements and incentivize redevelopment. The site is also adjacent to a Targeted Activity Center, highlighting its role as a focal point for future economic growth and mixed-use activity in North Fort Collins.

Affordable housing
75 planned units on city owned land SW of site, reserved for affordable housing projects
100+ units of income restricted housing just East of the site
Mobile park community just west of the site. This provides an important source of naturally occurring affordable housing around the site

Planned Trail Development
Proposed Trails
The City of Fort Collins has created a Strategic Trails Plan to outline the development of new trails and mobility pathways. A few new trails are planned near our site.
Recreational Loops
Major recreational trail loops are within quick access of the site as well.
Planned Transit Development

Bus Rapid Transit Plan
The City has worked on a MAX BRT plan for the North College neighborhood. This area is being targeted for future transit expansion and development due to the economic growth that is being seen in the area. This plan was finalized in February of 2023. This plan, if implemented, would add a lot of mobility and safety measures for alternative transport to and from the North College neighborhood.

North College Corridor Plan
Positive Factors -

- Strong Community Support – Property owners, businesses, and residents largely agree the corridor needs revitalization, which gives the plan political and social momentum.
- Strategic Location – Its proximity to Downtown and the Poudre River makes it a prime area for redevelopment, offering opportunities to connect to existing cultural and economic hubs.
- Vision for Identity – The plan emphasizes creating a distinctive, “more like Downtown” character, aiming to preserve uniqueness (“fix the junky, but keep it funky”) while improving design and livability.

Negative Factors -

- Financing Gap – With $70M needed and only $20M realistically funded, the reliance on uncertain tools like TIF makes large-scale improvements difficult to implement.
- Restrictive Zoning & Regulations – Outdated standards, setbacks, and “Change of Use” requirements burden small projects and discourage incremental redevelopment.
- Infrastructure & Parcel Barriers – Floodplain restrictions, lack of drainage/irrigation systems, and fragmented small parcels make coordinated redevelopment costly and slow.

Main Takeaway -
The original North College Corridor Plan has failed because it’s a broken promise. The community was all ears when the concept was created, and the city of Fort Collins was eager to make it happen. However, due to anti growth regulation and other zoning restrictions, and

issues such as drainage and drastically increased pricing, the plan still hasn't seen much implementation. Many years later, Fort Collins is still inefficiently relying on TIF taxing to raise a majority of the funding.

Existing Structures and Layout
While no specific plans have been finalized, proactive community outreach by the FCURA is expected to accelerate soon and will likely include focused discussions of housing and a long-anticipated community center as important elements in any redevelopment program. FCURA closed on the purchase of a vacant former grocery store, on July 15, 2025

Existing infrastructure
Buildings outlined in red, including the primary structure on the site, are planned for demolition, opening redevelopment opportunities. The map also shows existing building footprints, sidewalk networks, and the underground water mainline, which carries a no-build provision.
Mediocre Pedestrian Circulation

- Sidewalks are present along North College Avenue, with crosswalks at intersections to facilitate pedestrian movement.
- Traffic signals at intersections include pedestrian phases, allowing safe crossing.

Optimal Parking Capacity

- The property covers approximately 4.69 acres.
- Parking Ratio: The parking ratio is 3.43 spaces per 1,000 square feet of leasable area, totaling approximately 175 parking spaces.

Problematic Parking Condition

- The parking lot's surface is facing deterioration, including cracks and uneven pavement, indicating a need for resurfacing.
- Adequate lighting is present, enhancing visibility and safety during nighttime hours.
- Clear signage is displayed, directing traffic flow and indicating parking areas.

Optimal Vehicular Circulation

- North College Avenue is a four-lane arterial street, accommodating high traffic volumes and facilitating efficient movement through the corridor.
- The area is equipped with traffic signals to manage vehicle flow and enhance safety at intersections.
- Multiple entry points are available, providing flexibility for vehicles entering and exiting the property.

Water
Public water main runs along N. College Ave frontage.
City has done recent water line work nearby; on-site pipes are older.
Service available by tying into the main.
Likely 8–12" main, enough to provide required fire flow (around 1,500 gpm or more).
Sanitary Sewer
Sewer mains run along College Ave and nearby streets.
Public system in good condition; private laterals may need updates.
Existing service, but new projects must reconnect or upsize if needed.

Typical 8–12" main, generally enough for commercial use.
Storm Drainage
Storm pipes and inlets along College Ave collect runoff from the site.
Site paving and drains show age; some ponding possible.
Connections exist, but redevelopment must add detention/water quality measures.
Public pipes handle current flow; on-site detention likely required.
Electric
Served by Fort Collins Utilities Light & Power, with distribution lines along the street.
Well-maintained system; on-site transformer may need upgrades.
Service available; larger uses may require new transformer.
Pad-mount transformer 75–1000+ kVA possible depending on load.
Natural Gas
Xcel Energy provides gas, with mains in the College Ave corridor.
Active system, no reported issues; on-site service unknown.
Service available; upgrades if demand increases.
Distribution mains 2–8", typically enough for retail or restaurant use.
Utilities and Infrastructure

Topography
The site sits at about 5,000 ft elevation in Fort Collins. It is largely flat with only a gentle slope (2–3%) toward North College Ave, which helps stormwater drain to the street.
Natural Drainage
Topography and Natural Features
Vegetation
Environmentally Sensitive Areas
Stormwater flows off the roof and large paved parking lot into curb inlets along College Ave. No streams or natural ditches run through the property. Ponding can occur in low spots of the lot during heavy rain.
Public maps from the City and County show no wetlands, protected habitats, or designated floodplains on this site. The parcel is fully urbanized and not within any sensitive natural area. The property is mostly impervious surface (building + parking lot). Vegetation is limited to small trees and shrubs along the lot edges and landscaped islands. No significant native habitat remains.

ADJACENT ZONES
Low Density Residential
Community Comercial - North College
Low Density Mixed-Use Neighborhood
Medium Density Mixed-Use Neighborhood
Manufactured Housing
Industrial
CS - Service Commercial District
- high traffic commercial corridor

- range of uses encouraged to transition from commerce (on a highway, arterial, or rail spur) to a less intensive use area or residential neighborhood

BUILDING TYPES

- mixed-use, apartment, row home, duplex
- ADU only w/ existing detached house
- all non-res must meet mixed-use and commerical standards

BUILDING STANDARDS

(applies only to Commercial Buildings. Mixed Use buildings adhere to MU standards)

- 3 Stories max.
- Affordable Housing Development Bonus: 5 Stories max.

The Land Use Structure Plan identifies 1636 N. College Avenue as part of an Urban Mixed Use. The site serves as a point of transition between low-density residential neighborhoods and more intensive commercial/industrial zones.

1906–1988: Site remained agricultural or vacant land. 1940–1960: Limited data available on surrounding parcels. From the available aerial pictures, it seems like the surrounding land had the same use.
1966–1995: Adjacent properties were a mix of commercial uses (north and south) and residential uses (west). This area of Fort Collins was one of the last neighborhoods to receive utilities. Making this part of North Fort Collins a continually underfunded part of the city
1988: Developed into an Albertsons grocery store, with a retail strip center and parking lot.
1988–2023: Commercial configuration remained largely unchanged.
2023, the Albertsons closed, leaving the center point of the shopping center abandoned.
Environmental Analysis
The site sits within a predominantly flat landscape, where subtle slopes guide surface water toward nearby wetlands and flood-prone areas. There is a marsh wetland area north of the site, along with a natural areas: Goose Hollow, just southeast, and Redwing just east of Greenbrain Village.

Dry Creek Basin natural features
The Dry Creek Master Plan identifies proposed ponds and channel improvements in proximity to the site, reflecting the basin's importance in mitigating flood risk and improving stormwater management. Understanding the site’s position within this basin is crucial for future development considerations, identifying floodplain dynamics, ecological connectivity, and stormwater infrastructure.

RIsks of Comtamination
In 2001, a sewer maintenance worker detected petroleum odors near the Valero gas station on the northwest side of the site at 1660 North College Avenue. Environmental testing confirmed the presence of petroleum-related contamination in both soil and groundwater.
An incident occurred at the King Soopers location to the north, at 1814 North College Avenue, where approximately 15 gallons of fuel were spilled by a customer. Subsequent investigations confirmed that contaminants had entered the soil.

Albertsons has two small emergency generators. They are not currently producing waste, but need to be considered when planning future land use.

Thank You